WEIHUA MA

School of Journalism and Communication
Nanjing University
cora.weihua@gmail.com
github.com/ma-weihua
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Education

Nanjing University — Nanjing, China
M.A. in Communication — 2025–Present

University of Tübingen — Tübingen, Germany
Exchange Student in Digital Humanities — 2024–2025

Nanjing University — Nanjing, China
B.A. in Journalism — 2021–2025

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[1] Waiting

Conference Papers

[3] **Ma, W.** (2026, November). The "Wukong" Effect: Mapping the Global Attention Spillover from Video Games to Source Novels. *National Communication Association (NCA) 112th Annual Convention*, New Orleans, United States.

[2] Xiao, X., & **Ma, W.** (2026, June). Causal Pathways of Influence: International News and Political Elite Attention. *International Communication Association (ICA) 76th Annual Conference*, Cape Town, South Africa.

[1] Xiao, X., & **Ma, W.** (2025, November). Games as a Medium: The Role of Black Myth: Wukong in Promoting the Overseas Dissemination of Journey to the West. *National Communication Association (NCA) 111th Annual Convention*, Denver, United States.

Under Review

[2] **Weihua Ma**, Xiaoxiao, & Chengjun Wang. The "Wukong" Effect: How Video Games Generate Attention Spillover in Cross-Cultural Communication (Under Review)

[1] Xiaoxiao, Yaotian Zhang, **Weihua Ma**, & Chengjun Wang. Reversing the Information Subsidy: International News and the Political Leader's Attention in China (Under Review)

Selected Works in Progress

[2] Surprise Me, But Not Too Much: Style Deviation and Public Engagement among U.S. State Legislators on X (with Yuehong Cassandra Tai; Data analysis in progress)

[1] Affective Polarization and Ideological Divides: Policy Preferences, Partisan Sorting, and Political Values (Data analysis in progress)

Grants

External

- National Social Science Foundation of China (22BXW032), ¥200,000, Research Fellow — 2022–2025

  Project title: *Computational Narrative Research on Chinese Stories and Chinese Voices in the Digital Media Era* (PI: Cheng-Jun Wang)

Internal

- Jiangsu Province Graduate Research and Practice Innovation Program (26CXJH0090), ¥8,000, PI — 2026–2027

  Project title: *The "Wukong" Effect: How Digital Games Generate Attention Spillover to Classic Chinese Narratives*

Awards & Honors

- Outstanding Student of the 2023–2024 Academic Year, Nanjing University (University Level) — 2025
- China International College Students' Innovation Competition 2024 (Gold Award, National Level) — 2024
- 27th Nanjing University Basic Sciences Forum (Second Prize, University Level) — 2024

Skills

- **Statistical Programming Languages:** R, Python, Stata, SPSS, SQL
- **Languages:** Mandarin, English